

8.9 Essential Gaming Facts

<http://snipurl.com/digitgame14>

We thought we should end this chapter with some essential facts. The theme of this paper is “Who plays what?” Here are some excerpts from that paper, entitled “2005: Sales, Demographic and Usage Data - Essential Facts About The Computer and Video Game Industry.”

- m 75 per cent of heads of households in the US play computer or video games.
- m The average game player age is 30.
- m 19 per cent of Americans over the age of 50 played video games in 2004, an increase from 9 per cent in 1999.
- m The average age of the most frequent game purchaser
- m 12 is the average number of years adult gamers have been playing.
- m 53 % of game players expect to be playing as much or more 10 years from now as they do today.
- m In 2004, 53 per cent of video game sales were for those rated ‘E’ (Everyone); the figures for ‘T’ (Teen) and ‘M’ (Mature) were 30 and 16 respectively.

The best-selling video game genres:

- m 30 per cent Action
- m 18 per cent Sports
- m 10 per cent Shooters
- m 10 per cent Children & Family Entertainment
- m 9 per cent Racing
- m 9 per cent Role-Playing
- m 5 per cent Fighting

The best-selling computer game genres:

- m 30 per cent Strategy
- m 20 per cent Family & Children’s
- m 16 per cent Shooters
- m 10 per cent Role-Playing
- m 6 per cent Adventure